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09.10 Introduction

The Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (OBRA) of 1987 provides for Pre- Admission Screening Resident Review (PASRR) requirements. The PASRR Program is designed to screen individuals prior to nursing home placement. Identified individuals who have a suspected serious mental illness or intellectual disability/ related disability are referred through the Level II process to determine the need for nursing facility services and specialized services or specialized rehabilitation services. Title XIX certified nursing facilities are prohibited from admitting any new resident who has a suspected serious mental illness (MI) or intellectual disability/ related disability, unless it has been determined the individual requires the level of services provided by the nursing facility and whether the individual needs specialized services or specialized rehabilitation services for mental illness or intellectual disability/ related disability.

PASRR was created in 1987 through language in the Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act (OBRA) and has three goals:

- Identify individuals with mental illness (MI) and/or intellectual disability (ID) or related disability (RD). Previously termed mental retardation (MR)
- Ensure individuals are placed appropriately, whether in the community or in a nursing facility; and
- Ensure individuals receive the services required for Mental Illness or Intellectual Disability or related disability.

Prior to admission, the **CLTC reviewer or designee** will initiate the Level I Screening to identify those individuals suspected of having mental illness or intellectual disability/ related disability. If the individual has or is suspected of having an intellectual disability/ related disability or a serious mental illness, the case will proceed through the Level II evaluation process.

A signed Memorandum of Agreement with the Department of Health and Human Services allows hospitals and nursing facilities to complete the Level I Screening and portions of Level II Screening. The Level I Screening will be completed by nurses (RN or LPN) or social workers (to include social work designees or social services' workers).

Nursing Facilities Responsibilities

Nursing facilities are to comply with pre-admission screening mandates of PASRR without exception. Any instance of non-compliance should be reported to SCDHHS Nursing Facility Program Area. Failure to meet this requirement will result in recoupment action by the South Carolina Department of Health and Human Services.

The nursing facility must initiate a new Level I/Level II screening and review for any resident when there is a significant change in the resident's condition related to suspected serious mental illness or intellectual disability or related disability.

The **CLTC reviewer** will provide medical and/ or technical assistance to the facility as requested. The State must ensure follow-up care for those individuals determined to be in need of specialized services through the PASRR process.

Nursing Facilities are responsible for initiating a Level II PASRR process for any resident who has experienced a significant change related to a suspected serious mental illness or intellectual disability or related disability.

These responsibilities include the following:

- Initiating treatment to meet immediate needs and begin the comprehensive assessments process.
- Completing Minimum Data Set (MDS) and Resident Assessment Protocols (RAPs) as required.
- Completing Care Plan revisions within seven (7) business days.
- Arranging for the completion of the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Level II if the resident is being referred due to a serious mental illness.
- Forwarding the Level II packet to the appropriate State Authority(ies) by the twenty-first (21st) day following discovery of a significant change. Refer to 09.26.10 and 09.26.20 for a list of Level II packet forms.

Note: The State Authority must complete the written determination within seven (7) business days.

- Reviewing the determination with the resident and/or responsible party and Interdisciplinary Team.
- Addressing recommendations in the care plan.

PASRR Forms are available in the South Carolina Medicaid Nursing Facility Services Manual located at www.scdhhs.gov.

09.20 CLTC PASRR Policy and Procedure

09.21 Referrals for PASRR

All admissions to a Title XIX certified nursing facility require pre-admission screening regardless of pay source. A referral for this screening may originate from any knowledgeable source such as:

- Applicant
- Family member
- Interested neighbor or friend
- Physician
- Hospital staff
- Nursing home staff
- Staff of a public or private agency
- Medicare-Medicaid Plan

Agencies that may make referrals include the Department of Social Services (DSS), Department of Health and Environmental Control (DHEC), Department of Mental Health (DMH), Department of Disabilities and Special Needs (DDSN), home health agencies, etc.

A referral for nursing home pre-admission review must be referred to CLTC Centralized Intake or completed by participating nursing homes or hospitals.

Level I Screens completed by nursing facilities or hospitals **must be batched and forwarded to the CLTC Area Office for review**. The reviewed/ signed Level I screen will not be returned to the admitting facility unless the **CLTC reviewer** determines changes are needed based on the review.

Note: Designated CLTC staff keys the application, Participant Information, and Level I determination and routes forms to the designated **CLTC reviewer** for review. It is important for these screenings to be reviewed timely for completeness and accuracy. Any problems should be resolved with the facility by contacting the assessor for clarification or to request more information.

Hospitals should be encouraged to begin discharge planning and screen individuals as soon as possible to facilitate the PASRR process and allow ample time for any subsequent evaluation needed.

Nursing Facilities should confirm that PASRR Level I and Level II processes are complete prior to admitting the individual to the facility. In cases where the individual is admitted to the Nursing Facility without the appropriate screening, the Nursing Facility will be responsible for completing the required screening and for arranging any specialized services or specialized rehabilitative services deemed necessary.

Centralized Intake Process:

- Receives referral for applicant requesting Pre-admission screening for nursing facility placement.
- Checks Phoenix for possible existing record.
- Screens the referral for appropriateness (Refer to Section 09.21.10.).
- Creates the appropriate application in Phoenix if there is no active PASRR or Pre-Admission Screening for Nursing Home Placement Application.
- Completes available Participant Information in Phoenix.
- Annotates in the Narrative, if referral is for PASRR only (non-Medicaid).
- Ensures a Nursing Home Placement Application is completed, if referral is for PASRR and Medicaid Level of Care Certification.
- Releases case to the CLTC Area Office.

Designated Area Office Staff Process:

- Receives documents and assigns the case to a **CLTC reviewer**.
- Determines if a PASRR has been completed within one year of the referral.
- If a PASRR has been completed within one year of the referral, will confirm the previous PASRR is scanned into Phoenix Scans and will document in the participant's narrative.

09.21.10 Appropriateness of Referrals for Level I Screening

Level I Screening is necessary in the following circumstances:

1. All new admissions to Title XIX certified nursing facilities regardless of pay source.
2. Prior to nursing home re-admission from a hospital for in- patient treatment of a psychiatric condition, if the applicant has exceeded the ten (10) calendar day bed hold.
3. Out-of-state transfers.

4. Respite care admissions to a nursing facility for up to fourteen (14) calendar days or less; respite care admissions to a hospital are not subject to Level I Screening.

Level I Screening is not necessary in the following circumstances:

1. Inter-facility transfers (from one Title XIX nursing facility to another Title XIX nursing facility) are not considered new admissions for purposes of PASRR and are not subject to Level I Screening. The transferring nursing facility is responsible for sending all PASRR information to the receiving facility.

Note: If an individual is hospitalized for a non-psychiatric related condition and enters a different nursing facility, a new PASRR is not necessary. The transferring nursing facility may supply a copy.

2. Admissions to facilities that are not certified for Medicaid participation.
3. Intra-facility conversions from one pay source to another.
4. Re-admission to Title XIX certified nursing facilities from a hospital, including hospitalization for in-patient psychiatric care if within the ten (10) day bed hold.
5. Individuals admitted to a nursing facility from a hospital for acute in-patient treatment of the same condition for which they were hospitalized where the nursing facility stay is anticipated to be less than thirty (30) calendar days, as certified in writing by a physician.
6. Swing bed or Administrative Days admissions.

09.21.11 Out-of-State Referrals

Individuals who are out-of-state and seeking admission to a South Carolina Title XIX nursing facility are subject to the pre-admission screening requirements. South Carolina will accept any state's Level I or Level II forms which include the necessary information, or the transferring state may complete the South Carolina Level I and/or Level II forms. CLTC must review and approve **all** out-of-state admissions. If the Level II evaluation indicates specialized services are required, the appropriate South Carolina State Authority must review the Level II packet and render a final determination prior to admission to the nursing facility. Nursing facilities must not admit any out-of-state individual who has not been appropriately screened prior to admission according to South Carolina PASRR policies.

CLTC reviewer:

- Receives referring state's PASRR information and scans the information into Phoenix Scans.
- Reviews thoroughness of information and inclusion of South Carolina requirements.
- Makes a recommendation regarding the need for further evaluation.
- If the CLTC reviewer's recommendation differs from the recommendation indicated by the reviewer, mails a copy of the corrected Level I screening to the admitting nursing facility.
- Initials and dates the Level I form.
- Routes the completed Level I form to the designated CLTC worker for scanning.

09.22 Confidentiality

As with all applicants, confidentiality is important. Due to the nature and type of information obtained and shared, confidentiality must be safeguarded for all applicants regardless of pay source.

09.23 Applicant Involvement

The assessor must attempt to involve the applicant as much as possible in the actual screening process. If the applicant is enrolled in CLTC waiver, Level I Screening may be completed by a **CLTC reviewer** by telephone.

Completion of the PASRR may include conferring with the applicant's physician or other professionals caring for the applicant. When an applicant is physically or mentally unable to participate in the interview, the legal guardian, Authorized Representative, and/or permitted caregiver may be interviewed for completion of the screening.

09.24 Consent

CLTC Consent Form 121 is required following current CLTC Policy and Procedure. Hospitals and nursing facilities that conduct PASRR Level I Screenings on non-Medicaid applicants are not required to obtain an informed consent.

A CLTC Consent Form 121 is required in order to share information with any agency or person other than the entity which completed the form.

09.25 Timeliness Standard for Completion of Level I Screening

CLTC's intent is to facilitate nursing home admission for all applicants regardless of pay

source. Attempts must be made to complete the Level I Screening and to communicate the findings as quickly as possible to the appropriate parties. The Level I Screening Form will be completed **within ten (10) business days** of assignment to a **CLTC reviewer** or referral to an entity designated to complete the screening. Cases must be prioritized according to the individual needs of applicants. Hospitalized applicants should be screened as soon as possible following referral. Any delay in the PASRR process should be reported to the **Lead Team Nurse Consultant** or the **Area Administrator** and referral source and documented in the Narrative in Phoenix.

09.26 Accurate PASRR Level I Completion

The Level I Screening Form, must be completed accurately and appropriately by telephone or visit using all available information. When the screening is completed by the **CLTC reviewer**, the Phoenix version of the PASRR will be used. When the screening is completed by a nurse or social worker (or social services designee) outside of SCDHHS, the Level I Screening Form, SCDHHS Form 234, will be used. The assessor will first attempt to obtain the information from the applicant or Authorized Representative. However, information may also be obtained from the physician or other permitted caregiver supports. The assessor should consider the validity of the information received.

A team conference is required to review the information and render a joint recommendation. The form must be signed and dated by the assessor and by the reviewer if completed by CLTC. The SCDHHS Form 234 must be signed by the assessor and initialed and dated by the **CLTC reviewer** if completed by another entity. For pre-admission screening purposes, **Level I Screenings are valid for one year, unless there are significant changes in the applicant's condition which warrants a new Level I Screening.** The Level I can be updated by the assessor or designee **within a one-year period** to verify the continued appropriateness of the screening. Any information added to the Level I as an update shall be entered in the corresponding comments section. Any comments added as an update must be initialed and dated. If significant changes have occurred, a new Level I must be completed.

The assigned **CLTC reviewer**:

- Receives assignment for PASRR screening.
- Contacts applicant and/or Authorized Representative for completion of Level I Screening.
- Obtains the CLTC Consent Form in Phoenix. Consent must be obtained from the Authorized Representative if applicant requests or is unable to sign.
- Completes Level I Screening following PASRR User's Guide instructions.
- Enters information into PASRR Sections of Phoenix.

- Signs and dates the assessor fields in Phoenix.
- Consults with a second **CLTC reviewer** and makes a team decision regarding the need for further evaluation. The reviewer signs and dates the reviewer fields.
- Updates other sections of Phoenix as appropriate.

The recommendation regarding the need for further evaluation is based on the professional judgment of the **CLTC reviewer team**. The **CLTC reviewer** is responsible for ensuring the Level I Screening Form is properly completed prior to making a recommendation. Input from the **Lead Team Nurse Consultant, Area Administrator** and/or **Central Office Staff** **may be needed if the team is unable to reach a consensus**. Applicants should not be admitted to a nursing facility if indicators of serious Mental Illness or Intellectual Disability/Related Disability are identified, until the **CLTC reviewer team** completes the team review.

- If the recommendation is for **“No Further Evaluation”**, the assigned **CLTC reviewer**
 - Checks the appropriate field in the Level I Screen
 - Signs and dates as the assessor
 - Team staffs the recommendation with another CLTC reviewer
 - **The reviewer** signs and dates in the Reviewer section.
- If **“Indicators are present, but no further evaluation is recommended,”** the assigned **CLTC reviewer**
 - Checks the appropriate field in the Level I Screen
 - Provides justification for the recommendation in the comment section
 - Signs and dates as the assessor
 - Team staffs the recommendation with another **CLTC reviewer**
 - **The reviewer** signs and dates in the reviewer section.
- Keys PASRR information into Phoenix as appropriate.
- Sends a copy of Level I Screening Form to the nursing facility if applicant has finalized plans for specific nursing facility placement.
- The date sent and to whom must be keyed under the PASSR tab labeled “Facility” in Phoenix when the form is routed for mailing.

09.26.10 Appropriateness for Referrals to Level II Evaluation – Mental Illness

The federal definition of Mental Illness for PASRR is best understood in terms of the four “D’s”:

- **A diagnosis or suspicion** of a major mental illness such as schizophrenia, bipolar disorder, major depression, or an anxiety disorder.
- **An absence of dementia.** If dementia is also present (co-morbid with) Mental Illness, dementia is not the primary diagnosis. The individual’s Mental Illness must be more serious than dementia.
- **A well-defined duration.** To be relevant, intensive psychiatric treatment for Mental Illness must have taken place within the last two (2) years.
- **A particular level of disability.** The individual’s Mental Illness must have resulted in functional limitations in major life activities within the past 3 to 6 months. **The individual need not have received treatment.** The severity of the impairment and how recently it occurred are important, not whether the individual was hospitalized or was seen by a mental health professional.

If the CLTC reviewer team’s decision is **“Recommend further evaluation based on mental illness indicators.”** the assigned **CLTC reviewer** completes the following activities:

- Explains rationale for basis of the recommendation in the comment section.
- Completes the corresponding PASRR sections in Phoenix.
- Creates an electronic referral to Centralized Intake for a nursing home placement application if the original referral was for non-Medicaid PASRR. This will enable the **CLTC reviewer** to complete the required Phoenix Assessment.
- Once the application is released to the CLTC Area Office and assigned to the **CLTC reviewer**, completes an assessment in Phoenix.
- If the applicant does not meet level of care and has a primary pay source other than Medicaid, the process can continue.
- Obtains or completes the Mental Illness Social History.
- Obtains copies of the applicant’s most recent history and physical, pertinent medical records and/or treatment plans.
- Arranges for a physician, not affiliated with South Carolina Department of

Mental Health, to complete the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Level II, SCDHHS Form 250. (For directions for form use and billing instructions, refer to section 09.27.)

- Keys PASRR information in the applicant’s narrative and PASRR tab in Phoenix as the evaluation proceeds.
- Prepares and mails, faxes or hand-delivers the review packet to the South Carolina Department of Mental Health following receipt of the completed PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Level II, SCDHHS Form 250.
- The packet includes:
 - PASRR Cover Letter
 - Copies of the Level I Screening
 - Mini Mental State Exam (if applicable)
 - CLTC Consent Form 121
 - Assessment
 - Applicant’s current history and physical
 - Mental Illness Social History
 - PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Level II, SCDHHS Form 250
 - Other pertinent copies of the medical record

Note: All documents not created in Phoenix must be scanned into Phoenix Scans under the appropriate scan tags.

- If the final determination is not received from the State Authority within **five (5) business days**, the **CLTC reviewer** contacts South Carolina Department of Mental Health to determine the status of the evaluation and documents the contact in the applicant’s narrative.
- If no response is received within **seven (7) business days**, the **CLTC reviewer** notifies the Central Office Designee, Lead Team Nurse and/or Area Administrator of the delay.
- Receives South Carolina Department of Mental Health Final Determination and sends the PASRR Level I Screening Form, Mini Mental State Exam (if applicable), Psychiatric Evaluation Level II Form, Final determination from South Carolina Department of Mental Health and PASRR Notification Form to the applicant and/or Authorized Representative AND the admitting nursing facility.
- Keys PASRR data in Phoenix under the corresponding PASRR tabs. The date the final determination is signed by the State Authority or the date of the verbal notification by the State Authority will be used for the determination date.

- If specialized services are recommended which cannot be provided in the nursing facility, the **CLTC reviewer** sends a copy of the final determination form to the Central Office Designee.

A PASRR Level II evaluation is not required for all applicants exhibiting behavioral or adaptation problems. Only applicants who have or are suspected to have a serious mental illness must be referred to Level II.

A serious mental illness is defined in terms of diagnosis, behavior, and recent treatment history. These four (4) components are identified below.

I. Diagnosis: (confirmed or suspected)

- Schizophrenia
- Bi-polar disorder
- Severe mood/panic/anxiety disorder
- Severe depression
- Other psychotic disorder
- Personality disorder
- Somatoform disorder
- Other mental disorder that may lead to a chronic disability

AND

II. Impairment:

Level of impairment - The disorder has resulted in functional limitations in major life activities within the past 3 to 6 months. An individual typically has at least one of the following characteristics on a continuing or intermittent basis:

- a. Interpersonal functioning - The individual has serious difficulty interacting appropriately and communicating effectively with other persons, has a possible history of altercations, evictions, firing, fear of strangers, avoidance of interpersonal relationships and social isolation.
- b. Concentration, persistence, and pace - The individual has serious difficulty in sustaining focused attention to permit the completion of tasks commonly found in work settings or in work-like structured activities, such as, in school or home settings; manifests difficulties in concentration; unable to complete simple tasks within an established time period, makes frequent errors, or requires assistance in the completion of these tasks.

- c. Adaptation to change - The individual has serious difficulty adapting to typical changes in circumstances associated with work, school, family, or social interaction; manifests agitation, exacerbated signs and symptoms associated with the illness, or withdrawal from the situation; or requires intervention by the mental health or judicial system.

OR

III. Treatment:

Recent Treatment - The treatment history indicates that the individual has experienced at least one of the following:

- Psychiatric treatment more intensive than outpatient care and more than once in the past 2 years (e.g., partial hospitalization or inpatient hospitalization).

OR

- Within the last 2 years, due to mental disorder, experienced an episode of significant disruption to the normal living situation, for which supportive services were required to maintain functioning at home, or in a residential treatment environment, or which resulted in intervention by housing or law enforcement officials.

BUT

IV Dementia:

Not a primary diagnosis of dementia, including Alzheimer's disease or a related disorder, or a non-primary diagnosis of dementia unless the primary diagnosis is a serious mental illness. Dementia must be confirmed by the completion of Mini- Mental State Exam, if this is the basis for the recommendation for no further evaluation.

Note: The Mini-Mental State Exam is a copyrighted form. A blank form may not be copied. These forms must be ordered through CLTC Central Office. Once the form is completed with participant information, the form may be copied for participant record purposes.

Applicants who have attempted suicide within the past 2 years or who are considered a danger to self or others, must be referred for Level II evaluation, even if all above criteria are not met. The appropriate recommendation should be checked on the Level I Screening and the Comment Section should be utilized to explain the basis for the recommendation.

All medications will be reviewed for psychotropic/ psychoactive drugs to determine whether they are prescribed for control of physical non-psychiatric conditions, a minor mental illness, or a serious mental illness. If the applicant is maintained on a psychotropic/psychoactive drug with no significant impairment, referral to Level II is not required.

Any applicant seeking discharge from an Institute of Mental Disease (IMD) must be evaluated through the Level II process prior to admission to a Title XIX nursing facility. The Level I and Level II Screenings will be completed per agreement with the South Carolina Department of Mental Health facility. Since the Institute of Mental Disease is part of the State Mental Health Authority, a physician or psychiatrist independent of the determining authority, must complete the psychiatric evaluation concerning placement options and specialized service needs. Final determinations regarding the need for continued specialized services must be made by the appropriate State Authority.

Note: All corresponding Level II MI tabs under the PASRR section in Phoenix must be completed.

09.26.20 Appropriateness for Level II Evaluation -Intellectual Disability (ID)

The presence of an Intellectual Disability (ID) or diagnosis of a related disability requires Level II review. To qualify as having Intellectual Disability (ID) for the purposes of PASRR, an individual must have significantly sub-average general intellectual functioning. This is defined as an IQ score of less than seventy (70), as measured by a standardized, reliable test of intellectual functioning. An individual must also have concurrent impairments in adaptive functioning, manifested during the developmental period. These impairments must have emerged prior to the age eighteen (18) and must be likely to persist throughout the person's life. Intellectual Disability (ID) encompasses a wide range of conditions and levels of impairment.

Related disabilities include severe, chronic disabilities that are not an intellectual disability, which occurred before age twenty-two (22) and are expected to continue indefinitely. These conditions often produce similar functional impairments and/ or adaptive behavior and require similar treatment or services as intellectual disabilities. Some examples of related disabilities may include Down's syndrome, fetal alcohol syndrome, cerebral palsy, seizure disorder, autism, traumatic brain injury, etc. Related disabilities must result in substantial functional imitations in three (3) or more of the following major life activities:

- Self-care
- The Understanding and Use of language Learning
- Mobility

- Self-direction
- Capacity for independent living

Any applicant seeking discharge from a SCDDSN facility must be reviewed by CLTC through the Level II process prior to admission to a Title XIX nursing facility.

Note: If a resident with a diagnosis of ID/RD has exceeded the 10 day bed hold a new Level II is required. If the Level II PASRR has been completed in the past year, it may be updated in the comment section.

If the CLTC reviewer team's decision is **“Recommend further evaluation based on Intellectual Disability”** the assigned CLTC reviewer completes the following activities:

- Explains rationale for basis of recommendation in the comment section.
- Completes the corresponding PASRR sections in Phoenix.
- Creates an electronic referral to Centralized Intake for a nursing home placement application if the original referral was for Non-Medicaid PASRR. This will enable the CLTC reviewer to complete the required Phoenix Assessment.
- Once the application is released the CLTC Area Office and assigned to the CLTC reviewer, completes an assessment in Phoenix.
- If the applicant does not meet level of care and has a primary pay source other than Medicaid, the process can continue.
- Obtains or completes the Intellectual Disability Social History.
- Obtains copies of the applicant's most recent history and physical, pertinent medical records and/or treatment plans.
- Keys PASRR information in the applicant's narrative and PASRR tab in Phoenix as the evaluation proceeds.
- Prepares and mails, faxes or hand-delivers the review packet to the South Carolina Department of Disabilities and Special Needs.
- The packet includes:
 - PASARR Cover Letter
 - Copy of the Level I Screening
 - CLTC Consent Form 121
 - Assessment
 - Applicant's current history and physical

- Intellectual Disability Social History
- Other pertinent copies of medical record

Note: All documents not created in Phoenix must be scanned into Phoenix scans under the appropriate scan tags.

- If the final determination is not received from the State Authority within five (5) business days, the **CLTC reviewer** contacts the South Carolina Department of Disability and Special Needs to determine the status of the evaluation and documents the contact in the applicant's narrative.
- If no response is received within seven (7) business days, the **CLTC reviewer** notifies the **Central Office Designee, Lead Team Nurse** and/or **Area Administrator** of the delay.
- Receives the South Carolina Department of Disabilities and Special Needs Final Determination and sends PASRR Level I Screening Form, Mini-Mental State Exam if applicable, Level II Form, Final Determination from Department of Disabilities and Special Needs and PASRR Notification Form.
- Keys PASRR data in Phoenix under the corresponding PASRR tabs. The date the final determination is signed by the State Authority or the date of the verbal notification by the State Authority will be used for the determination date.
- If specialized services are recommended which cannot be provided in the nursing facility, the **CLTC reviewer** sends a copy of the final determination form to the Central Office Designee.

Note: All corresponding, Level II ID tabs under the PASRR section in Phoenix must be completed.

09.26.30 Appropriateness for Level II Evaluation - Dual Diagnosis of MI/ID

For applicants diagnosed with both intellectual disability and serious mental illness (dually diagnosed) both State Authorities must conduct a Level II review.

09.27 Level II Review

Based on the Level I review, an applicant suspected of having a serious mental illness or intellectual disability must be referred for Level II evaluation.

09.27.10 Processing Level II Psychiatric Evaluation Claims for Medicaid Applicants.

The assigned **CLTC reviewer**:

- Completes the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Medicaid applicants, obtains the **Area Administrator's** signature and mails form to the physician along with the Level II Psychiatric Evaluation Form, SCDHHS Form 250.
- Receives the completed Psychiatric Evaluation and prepares the Level II packet.
- Physician bills directly using Health Insurance 1500 Claim Form.

Note: If the Health Insurance 1500 Claim Form is received in the CLTC Area Office, the **CLTC reviewer** forwards it to:

Medicaid Claims Receipt
P. O. Box 1412
Columbia, SC 29202

09.27.20 Processing Level II Psychiatric Evaluation Claims for Non- Medicaid Applicants

The assigned **CLTC reviewer**:

- Completes the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Non- Medicaid Applicants, obtains the **Area Administrator's** signature and mails form to the physician along with the Level II Psychiatric Evaluation Form, SCDHHS Form 250.
- Receives completed forms from physician. Scans the Level II Psychiatric Evaluation Form, SCDHHS Form 250, into Phoenix and adds the form to the Level II evaluation packet.
- Routes the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Non- Medicaid Applicants to **Support Staff**.

The **designated Support Staff**:

- Determines whether or not the physician has completed the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Non- Medicaid correctly.
- If name of the physician completing the form is not identical to the signature, contacts physician's office to obtain correct name or practice name.
- Verifies physician's name/ Practice name has a corresponding social security number or Federal ID number listed. Example: Dr. Solo Practice/247-09-

5555 **or** The Solo Practice Group/51-98765.

- If the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Non-Medicaid Applicants is complete, forwards the form to **Central Office** for processing and scans the form into Phoenix.
- If the PASRR Psychiatric Evaluation Request for Non-Medicaid Applicants is incomplete, confers with **CLTC reviewer** and calls physician's office to clarify/correct the information. Makes corrections and forwards to Central Office for processing.
- Forwards claim to Fiscal Affairs for processing.

Once Level II forms are completed, the appropriate State Authority must review all available information and make a final determination as to the need for specialized services. The Level II process of PASRR consists of a comprehensive review of the applicant's need for nursing home care and specialized services for a serious mental illness or intellectual disability. This determination of specialized services needs must be made by the appropriate State Authority. Level I and Level II determinations are valid for one year unless there is a significant change in the applicant's condition. Level II final determination forms from the state authority cannot be updated. A new complete Level I and Level II form must be completed if there are significant changes.

A significant change has the following characteristics:

- A major change
- Not self-limiting change (a disease process that resolves spontaneously with or without specific treatment)
- Impacts more than one area of the individual's health status; and
- Requires interdisciplinary review or revision of the care plan

Any individual determined to have a serious mental illness or intellectual disability through the Level II evaluation process, who is in need of specialized services but not in need of nursing home services, shall be considered inappropriate for placement or continued residence in a Medicaid-certified nursing facility. However, it is the responsibility of the appropriate state authority to provide or arrange for specialized services when it is required. The only exception to this would involve an applicant determined in need of specialized services who has resided in the facility for at least thirty (30) months.

09.27.30 Advanced Categorical Determination

The assigned **CLTC reviewer** completes the following activities:

- Reviews case and determines need for Advanced Categorical Determination.

- Completes Assessment by telephone or visit
- Explains rationale for basis of decision in Comment Section.
- Obtains any documentation to support decision; i.e., physician's progress notes, nursing home orders, etc.
- Checks Advanced Categorical Determination recommendation in Phoenix
- Enters PASRR data Phoenix
- Routes PASRR Notification Form and PASRR Level I Screening to the applicant and/or Authorized Representative and admitting facility.

09.27.31 Advanced Categorical Determination Group - Mental Illness

Certain individuals who require nursing facility care may meet criteria which will allow the **CLTC reviewer** to classify the individual for an advanced decision that specialized services or special rehabilitation services are not required. Because this is a Level II process, through an agreement with the State Authority, an Assessment, must be completed. Only the **CLTC reviewer** may apply these criteria. The circumstances in which these classifications are allowed are as follows:

1. The individual could not participate in or benefit from specialized services due to a comatose or semi-comatose state or functioning at brain stem level, as documented in the medical record.
2. The individual has an illness which results in a level of physical impairment so severe that the individual could not be expected to benefit from specialized services. In such cases, the individual's need for medical care overrides the need for specialized services.
3. The individual is being admitted to the nursing facility on a provisional basis for a period not to exceed fourteen (14) calendar days to provide respite for in-home caregivers.
4. The individual is being admitted to the nursing facility on a provisional basis not to exceed seven (7) calendar days while alternative arrangements can be made. The admission must be at the request of the South Carolina Department of Social Services, Division of Protective Services, due to suspicion of abuse or neglect on an emergency basis.
5. The individual is being admitted directly to the nursing facility from acute inpatient care for a period not to exceed thirty (30) calendar days, as certified by the attending physician. The admission must be for treatment of the same condition that necessitated the hospitalization and must not be due to a

psychiatric condition. If the individual's stay at the nursing home exceeds thirty (30) calendar days, the Level II process **MUST** be completed **by the fortieth (40th) calendar day**. It is the **CLTC reviewer's** responsibility to monitor all assigned cases for Advanced Determinations.

It is the **CLTC reviewer's** responsibility to monitor the time frame of a case for Advanced Determination.

09.27.32 Advanced Categorical Determination Group – Intellectual Disability

Certain individuals who require nursing facility care may meet criteria which will allow the **CLTC reviewer** to classify the individual for an advance decision that specialized services are not required. Because this is a Level II process through an agreement with the State Authority, both a medical assessment using the Form 1718 and the social history assessment under PASRR, must be completed. Only the **CLTC reviewer** may apply these criteria. The circumstances in which these classifications are allowed are as follows:

1. The individual has a diagnosis of dementia in combination with an intellectual disability or related disability. In these cases, the dementia diagnosis must be substantiated by a Mini-Mental State Examination.
2. The individual is being admitted to the nursing facility on a provisional basis for a period not to exceed fourteen (14) calendar days to provide respite for in-home caregivers.
3. The individual is being admitted to the nursing facility on a provisional basis not to exceed seven (7) calendar days while alternative arrangements can be made. The admission must be at the request of the South Carolina Department of Social Services, due to suspicion of abuse or neglect on an emergency basis.
4. The individual is being admitted directly to the nursing facility from an acute in-patient setting for a period not to exceed thirty (30) calendar days, as certified by the attending physician. The admission must be for treatment of the same condition that necessitated the hospitalization and may not be due to a psychiatric condition. If the applicant's stay at the nursing facility exceeds thirty (30) calendar days, the Level II must be completed **by the fortieth (40th) calendar day**.

It is the **CLTC reviewer's** responsibility to monitor the time frames of a case for Advanced Determination.

09.27.40 Level II Determination Notification

Upon receipt of a final determination from the State Authority, the **CLTC reviewer team** should review the summary and recommendations. Notification of the Level II determination is required and is communicated via the PASRR Notification Form. Because Advanced Categorical Determinations are Level II determinations, written notice is also required. A copy of the evaluation and final determination report(s) must be sent to the applicant and/or Authorized Representative and admitting nursing facility. **All corresponding MI or ID Final tabs must be completed in Phoenix.**

09.28 Timeliness for Completion of Level II Determinations

The state authority must make the Level II determination **within seven (7) business days** of referral. This report may be communicated by telephone or fax with written follow-up by mail. If no response is received within seven (7) business days, the **CLTC reviewer** notifies the Central Office Designee, Lead Team Nurse and/or Area Administrator of the delay.

09.30 PASRR Completed by Other Entities

Any PASRR completed by other entities (hospitals and nursing homes) via a Memorandum of Agreement must be batched weekly and sent to the Area Office for review by the **CLTC reviewer**. The **CLTC reviewer** will review the PASRR and initial if the PASRR is determined to be accurate, complete, and appropriate. The approved PASRR will be scanned into Phoenix and placed under the PASRR scan tag.

For applicants who have an existing Phoenix record (active or terminated), no other information is required to be recorded in Phoenix.

For applicants who do not have an existing Phoenix record, a new Participant Record must be created.

A PASRR application is not required for PASRR reviews.

The PASRR section in Phoenix which includes the recommendation and reviewer's signature is not required for a PASRR review.

If the PASRR completed via MOA is not accurate, complete or appropriate, the PASRR must be returned for correction.